

NIKITA RAI

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Professional Summary

Risk and Compliance Internal Audit Manager with 12+ years of global experience and MBA from The University of Edinburgh. Delivered \$7M+ in monetary recoveries through systematic controls testing across \$2M-\$372M projects in Technology, SaaS, and Financial Services. Expertise in SOX compliance, ISO standards, enterprise risk management (ERM), and 3 Lines of Defence frameworks. Built SOX-compliant control frameworks reducing gaps by 60% and led 13-member finance team. Proven ability to execute end-to-end audits, assess control effectiveness, drive remediations, and deliver impactful findings to board-level committees across global operations. Cross-industry expertise spanning global technology MNCs, media-tech SaaS, and agritech retail with varied business models from subscription-based to cash-intensive operations.

Key Skills

Risk Controls & Audit: Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) | Risk-Based Scoping & Assessment | GRC Systems (AuditBoard) | Control Gap Analysis | Internal Controls Design & Testing | Financial Reporting Controls | 3rd Party Due Diligence | Fraud Detection & Prevention | Audit Lifecycle Management | COSO Principles | Audit & Risk Committee Reporting

ISO Standards & Compliance: ISO Audit Support (ISO 27001, 9001, 31000, 19011, 37301, 28000) | ISO Management Systems | Familiarity with Environmental, ISO 55000 | SOX Compliance | GDPR | Regulatory Compliance | Sanctions & Export Controls

Finance: Budgeting | Forecasting | Financial Reporting | MIS Reporting | Cost Analysis | Variance Analysis | Internal Financial Controls (IFC) | GAAP | Cash Flow management | Authorization matrix

Technical Tools: Microsoft Office | Data Analysis & Visualization (Power BI, Tableau) | AI-Powered GRC Tools | GRC Platforms | ERP Systems (SAP) |

Professional Experience

Senior Audit Manager: Risk & Customer Audit Specialist (EMEA)|Oct 2022-Present

Intel Corporation (UK) Ltd

- Executed SOX-aligned onsite controls testing and audits across EMEA and Asia covering rebates ranging from **\$13 mil to \$220 mil**.
- **Owned full audit cycle** encompassing risk-based analysis, designing test of controls, contract analysis, traveling onsite, budgeting, evidence gathering, workpaper management, results evaluation, and audit closure
- Drove **monetary recoveries and ranging from \$80k to \$6.85 mil** and partner compliance improvements through systematic control deficiency identification and corrective action program.
- Performed risk-based scoping by analysing large data sets through internal **dashboards, AI powered tools**, and external sources to assess control risks for **projects valuing between \$2 mil and \$372 mil**.
- **Designed and conducted training/learning sessions** for the auditors across the globe through actual audit cases to identify control gaps, assess risk tolerance, and design tests of controls
- Prepared high-impact, **executive level audit reports** for senior management and **board-level compliance committees** with control gaps analysis, risks insights and risk mitigation recommendations.
- **Extensively travelled across EMEA & Asia** to conduct on-site process walkthroughs, interviews, warehouse & manufacturing facility inspection and internal control effectiveness assessments while evaluating regulatory compliance, **fraud prevention, sanctions, export controls, and GDPR adherence**
- Drove customer compliance through **strategic negotiation** and relationship building, **influencing key decisions** that strengthen operational controls and authorization processes.
- Led strategic advisory engagements and consulting projects including process improvement, **fraud investigation escalations, cost benefit analysis, operation risk assessment for government tenders** and high-value Intel components.
- **Designed SOX-compliant control testing frameworks** and audit procedures tailored to complex customer profiles, including control matrices and test scripts **aligned with COSO principles**

Finance Manager | Sep 2020 - Sep 2021

Clover Ventures Pvt Ltd

Agritech startup in Bangalore connecting farmers directly to consumers and B2B clients (hotels, caterers, supermarkets) through online platform and supply chain operations. High-growth, cash-intensive business requiring strong financial controls across multi-state operations

- **Led 13-member finance team** managing ₹100M+ multi-channel revenue
- Managed **cash flow, forecasting and liquidity** across 3 banks; optimized cash positioning for seasonal working capital
- **Detected and addressed ₹0.6M fraud** through control framework
- Supported business transformation through control framework implementations and process improvement initiatives; **reduced control gaps by 60%** at Clover and working capital cycle by 40%
- **Reduced working capital cycle by 40%** and vendor costs by 35% through payment term negotiations with 70+ suppliers
- Delivered Series B reporting, **burn rate analysis, 13-week cash flow projections**, and investor MIS

Finance Manager | Mar 2017 - Aug 2020

Quintype Technologies Pvt Ltd (Quintype Inc)

New York-headquartered media-tech SaaS company providing digital publishing platform to 300+ publishers globally with subscription-based revenue model. Managed financial operations including investor relations, Series B due diligence coordination, and recurring revenue accounting for high-growth startup.

- **Managed financial planning, budgeting, and reporting** for ₹80M+ turnover; reduced costs by 25% and working capital cycle by 15% via contract restructuring
- Maintained banking relationships and **managed cash flow for operational liquidity; monitored cash positions** and optimized payment scheduling
- Oversaw **statutory/internal** audits as primary external auditor liaison; coordinated audit queries ensuring timely completion
- **Managed vendor payment cycles** and credit term negotiations; recovered ₹3.8M through escalation resolution
- Established internal control framework over financial reporting covering payroll, expense authorization, and month-end close; **improved process efficiency by 30%**
- Owned consolidated reporting under **US GAAP, including revenue recognition for subscription-based SaaS model, deferred revenue accounting**, and investor reporting packages.

Education

MBA, The University of Edinburgh | 2021-2022

Specializations: Strategy, Operational Improvement, Finance

Chartered Accountant (ACA), The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) | 2008-2012

Integrated Professional Competency Course | Common Proficiency Test